



IN BRIEF

REFUGEE CRISES

Since 1951, the United Nations has worked to support refugees across the globe, but it is only recently that the struggles of refugee women have received extra attention.

1900

- **1939-1945** 40 million European men, women, and children are displaced by World War II—one example is the real life Maria Von Trapp, who left Austria for the US in 1942.
- **1951** The United Nations defines refugees and their rights to asylum in the Convention Relating to the Status of Refugees.
- **1956** The Hungarian Revolution causes around 200,000 people to flee the country.
- **1975-1990s** After the Vietnam War, millions flee by boat to escape persecution by the communist government; some of these refugees are women who had children by American men.
- **1979-1989** The Soviet invasion of Afghanistan creates 6.3 million new refugees, including Maryam Monsef, who became the Canadian Minister of Status of Women in 2017.
- **1989** The Women's Refugee Commission is formed as part of the International Rescue Committee; it becomes independent in 2014.
- **1992** 5.7 million people are displaced by the civil war in Mozambique, Africa.

2000

- **2005** US forces invade Iraq; the war displaces 1.9 million men, women, and children.
- **2009** US President Obama rules that foreign women may seek asylum from domestic violence.
- **2011** War in Syria forces 12 million people to flee their homes in search of safety; the majority are women.
- **2013** Civil war breaks out in Sudan; more than two million people flee their homes.
- **2015** "Boat people" flee from Myanmar (Burma) in the Rohingya refugee crisis; an estimated 80 percent of the refugees are women and children.

◀ **A US MARINE GUARDS VIETNAMESE WOMEN AND CHILDREN IN 1965, WHEN 3 MILLION PEOPLE FLED FROM NORTH TO SOUTH VIETNAM.**

